

Leave the driver in the locker.
Middle of the green.
Look up.

Four and a half thousand yards of the same dunes. It doesn't count, so play it like it does.

HODUS 50TH · IRELAND · SEPTEMBER 2026
Royal County Down · Royal Portrush · Portstewart · Rosapenna

HODUS 50TH · SEPTEMBER 2026

The
Annesley

Royal County Down · Newcastle, Co. Down



Field Guide

White tees · Par 67 · 4,594 yards
George Combe · Donald Steel · Mackenzie & Ebert 2015

Quick Look

The holes that need a decision before you pull a club.

Leave the driver in the bag: everywhere but 2 and 16 Thirteen par 4s, one of them 400, the rest between 258 and 349 on 25-yard fairways. Hybrid and wedge is the day.

Hardest by index: 6, 16, 9, 12 The 6th is the pick of the course and stroke index 1: 25 yards wide, no bunkers, native grass both sides, small green with a steep falloff left.

Scoring chances: 17, 18, 4, 1 Short par 4s where an iron and a wedge is a birdie look. 17 is drivable in a helping wind; 18 is the easiest on the card.

Par 3s: 3, 7, 11, 13, 14 Between 113 and 140 yards, every one a wedge or short iron to a small tilted green. Middle, two putts, walk.

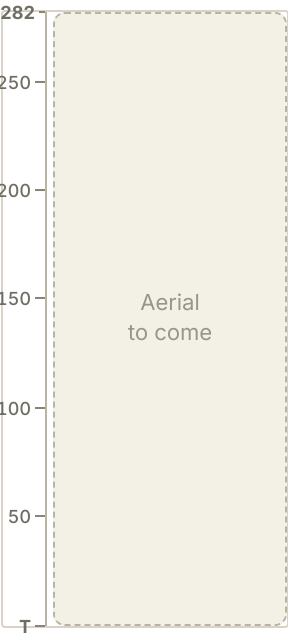
The new holes: 9, 10, 11 The 2015 loop around the big dune. Bolder ground than the rest, the best views on the property, and the 10th runs along the beach.

Photos: 9 tee, 10, 8 green From the 9th tee back across the Championship to the Slieve Donard spires and the Mourne. The 10th tee by the sea. The dunes beyond the 8th green.

Greens Small, perched and sloping, with run-offs all round. Distance control is the whole examination; fly it to the middle.

1 PAR 4 · 282 YDS · SI 11

IRON / HYBRID OPENER GUIDE



TEE Iron or hybrid. At 282 there is nothing driver can do for you except find the native grass. Leave yourself a full wedge from the fairway.

LINE Center of the fairway.

IN Middle of the green, whatever the flag. The greens here are small and tilted; the middle is the only safe place.

NOTE The first of thirteen par 4s under 400 yards. Get the opening tee shot in play and the round settles down.

The same dunes as the Championship, a third shorter and half as wide. Read once, then go and enjoy it. Bold means Joe said it.

2. **The fairways are 25 to 30 yards wide.** Miss either side and it's native grass, not rough — a lost ball, not a bad lie. Position beats distance on every tee. Give yourself a buffer from whichever side is worse.

3. Small greens, sloping, with run-offs. Distance control is the whole game here. The greens are perched and tilted, and short or long rolls off. Fly it to the middle, take your two putts, walk.

4. Fewer clubs, more shots. The Fried Egg played it with four clubs and a putter and had the round of the trip. Half sets are welcome; creativity is the point. It is the warm-up, so warm up.

5. A few blind shots, not many. Far fewer than next door, but the dunes hide a green or two. Get the line from the marker or your playing partners and commit to it.

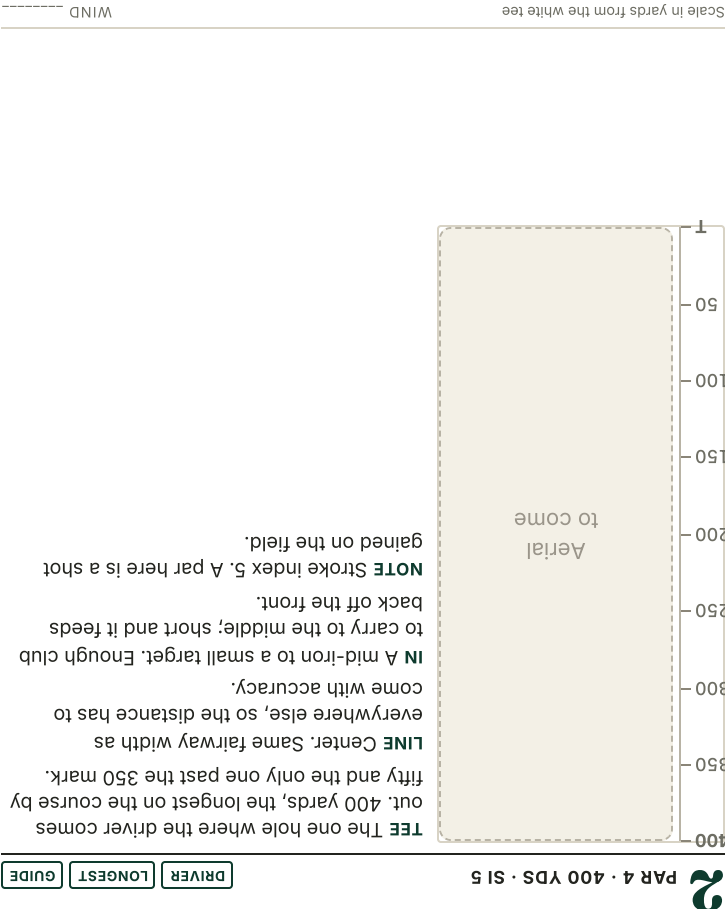
6. Stop at 9, 10 and 11. The 2015 holes circle the biggest dune on the property. The 9th tee looks back across the Championship links to the Slieve Donard spires and the Mourne's; the 10th runs closer to the beach than any of the 36 holes. Take the photo.

7. It doesn't count. Nothing here touches the match. Play it for the fun of it, sort out your caddie small talk, and find out how the ball is running in the dunes before it matters on Monday.

Sunday 13 September · 3 groups off the first tee · does not count towards the match

White tees, club scorecard. Last column is the call off the tee; bold is Joe's.

	IN	TOTAL
	33	67
	2224	4,594
11 Wedge. Middle.	3	113
12 Hybrid, center.	4	307
13 Short iron. Middle.	3	138
14 Short iron. Middle.	3	140
15 Iron or hybrid, center.	4	277
16 3W or driver, center.	4	349
17 Iron to a wedge, or have a go.	4	258
18 Fairway wood or long iron, then a short one.	4	314
	12	



18

PAR 4 · 314 YDS · SI 12



TEE A fairway wood or long iron, then a short shot in. National Club Golfer calls it the easiest hole on the card and a birdie chance to finish.

LINE Center.

IN Middle of the green.

NOTE Back to the clubhouse with the Championship 18th alongside. Same walk tomorrow, with the driver.

Scale in yards from the white tee

WIND _____

16

PAR 4 · 349 YDS · SI 2



TEE The second longest hole and stroke index 2. A 3-wood or a careful driver; this and the 2nd are the only tee shots that want length.

LINE Center of the fairway.

IN Mid-iron. Middle of the green, enough club to reach it.

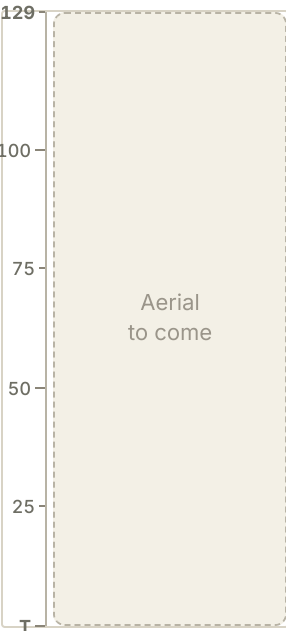
NOTE Par here and on the 6th wins the day.

Scale in yards from the white tee

WIND _____

3

PAR 3 · 129 YDS · SI 9



CLUB 129 yards, a wedge or a short iron. The first of the five par 3s.

LINE Middle of the green.

WATCH Here the course turns in toward the big dunes. Slopes and run-offs surround a small green; anything that misses the surface keeps going.

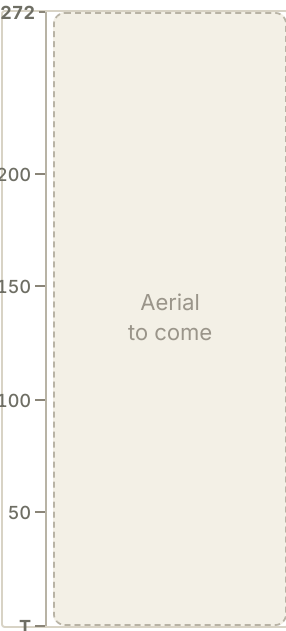
NOTE Stroke index 9 for a 129-yard hole tells you what the green is like.

Scale in yards from the white tee

WIND _____

5

PAR 4 · 272 YDS · SI 7



TEE Hybrid or long iron. From here to the 15th the Annesley threads the corridors between the Championship holes 11 through 17, so you are in the same dunes as tomorrow.

LINE Center.

IN Short pitch. Middle of the green.

NOTE Stroke index 7 on a 272-yard hole. The rating is about the green and the grass, not the length.

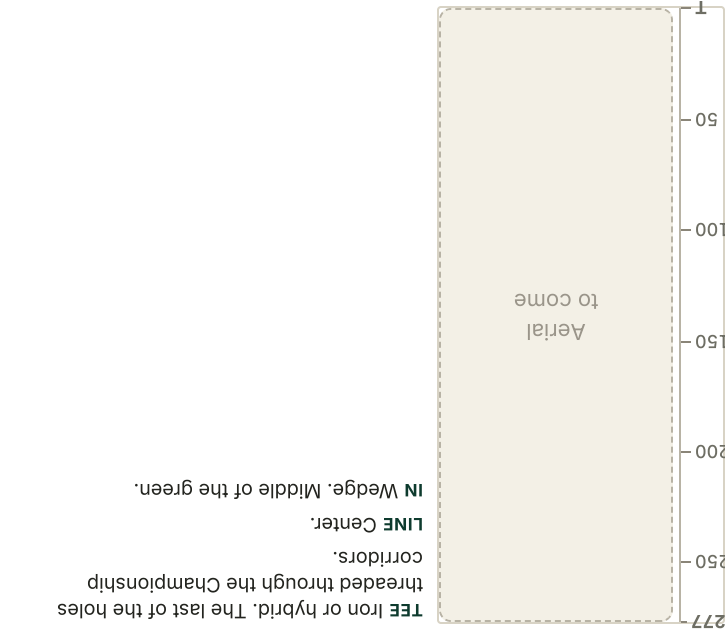
Scale in yards from the white tee

WIND _____



17 PAR 4 • 258 YDS • SI 16

DRIVABLE? SCORING GUIDE



15 PAR 4 • 277 YDS • SI 10

IRON / HYBRID GUIDE



4 PAR 4 • 267 YDS • SI 17

POSITION PERCHED GREEN GUIDE



6 PAR 4 • 338 YDS • SI 1

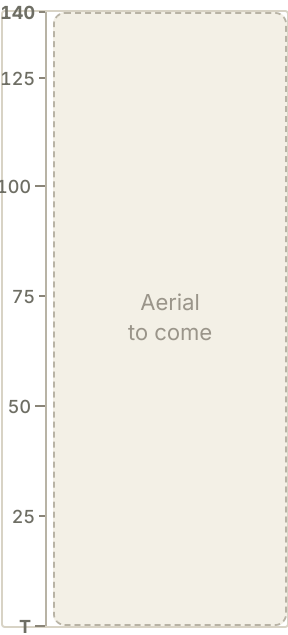
HYBRID NO BUNKERS SI 1 GUIDE

14

PAR 3 · 140 YDS · SI 14

SHORT IRON

GUIDE



CLUB 140 yards, the second of the pair. Two short holes in a row, two different greens.

LINE Middle of the green.

NOTE Stroke index 14.

Scale in yards from the white tee

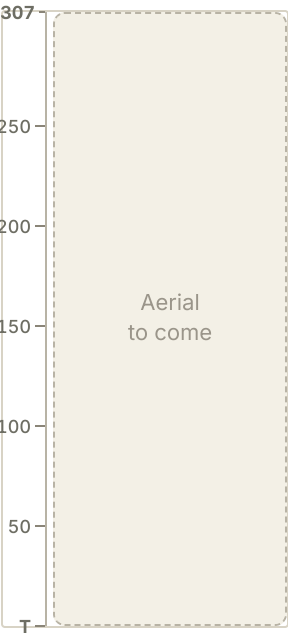
WIND _____

12

PAR 4 · 307 YDS · SI 4

HYBRID

GUIDE



TEE Hybrid. Back into the corridors between the Championship holes.

LINE Center. Stroke index 4, so the fairway is doing something; give yourself a buffer.

IN Middle of the green, enough club to carry the front.

Scale in yards from the white tee

WIND _____

7

PAR 3 · 124 YDS · SI 15

WEDGE

GUIDE



CLUB 124 yards, a wedge. The second shortest hole on the card.

LINE Middle of the green.

WATCH A short hole with a small green is a par or a bogey and rarely anything else. Take the middle and the two putts.

NOTE Stroke index 15.

Scale in yards from the white tee

WIND _____

9

PAR 4 · 294 YDS · SI 3

NEW 2015

PHOTO

SI 3

GUIDE



TEE The first of the three Mackenzie & Ebert holes routed around the largest dune on the property. Stand on the tee before you hit: from height it looks back across the Championship links to Newcastle, the Slieve Donard spires and the Mourne behind.

LINE Center. The new holes are bolder than the old ones, with more shaped ground; trust the middle.

IN Middle of the green.

NOTE Stroke index 3.

Scale in yards from the white tee

WIND _____

